

2Date: 14 December, 2025

- **Context Free Grammar**

- An alphabet of terminal letter from which we are going to form strings of a language.
- A set of symbols, called non-terminals
- Finite set of productions of the form:
 - One terminal $\rightarrow$ (produces) Strings of terminals AND / OR non-terminals
 - Non-terminals are on the left.

- **Example**

- ANY NUMBER $\rightarrow$ FIRST DIGIT
- FIRST DIGIT $\rightarrow$ FIRST DIGIT . OTHER DIGIT
- FIRST DIGIT $\rightarrow$ 1..9
- OTHER DIGIT $\rightarrow$ 0..9
- The above example cannot produce 0 (because first digit does not have 0 available)
- Single arrow ($\rightarrow$) Symbolic representation. Double arrow ($\Rightarrow$) when applying it numerically on an example.

- **Example*

- $S \rightarrow aS$
- $S \rightarrow \Lambda$
- One liner: $S \rightarrow aS \mid \Lambda$
 - Represents: a^*

- **Example**

- $S \rightarrow SS$
- $S \rightarrow a$
- One liner: $S \rightarrow SS \mid a$
 - Represents: a^+

- **Example**

- $S \rightarrow aS$
- $S \rightarrow bS$
- $S \rightarrow a$
- $S \rightarrow b$
- $S \rightarrow \Lambda$
- One liner: $S \rightarrow aS \mid bS \mid a \mid b \mid \Lambda$
 - Represents: $(a + b)^*$

- **Example**

- $S \rightarrow XaaX$
- $X \rightarrow aX \mid bX \mid \Lambda$
 - Represents: $(a+b)^*(aa)(a+b)^*$
- **Example**
 - $S \rightarrow S.S$
 - $S \rightarrow \text{Balanced}.S$
 - $S \rightarrow S.\text{Balanced}$
 - $S \rightarrow \Lambda$
 - $S \rightarrow \text{Unbalanced}.S.\text{Unbalanced}$
 - $\text{Unbalanced} \rightarrow ab \mid ba$
 - $\text{Balanced} \rightarrow aa \mid bb$
 - $\Lambda, aa, bb, abab, \dots$
 - Represents: even-even
- **Example**
 - $S \rightarrow aSa$
 - $S \rightarrow bSb$
 - $S \rightarrow a$
 - $S \rightarrow b$
 - $S \rightarrow \Lambda$
 - One-liner: $S \rightarrow aSa \mid bSb \mid a \mid b \mid \Lambda$
 - Represents: Palindrome strings
 - $S \rightarrow aSa \mid bSb \mid \Lambda$: represents palindrome strings of even length
 - $S \rightarrow aSa \mid bSb \mid a \mid b$: represents palindrome strings of odd length
- **Example**
 - $S \rightarrow aS \mid bb$
 - Or:
 - $S \rightarrow aS$
 - $S \rightarrow bb$
 - Represents: a^*bb
- **Example**
 - a^*b^*
 - Represented by: $S \rightarrow aS \mid \Lambda, S \rightarrow Sb \mid \Lambda$